Task Sheet No. 11:
TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

INSTRUCTION:

As a pre-service teacher, you are tasked to write a **Teaching Philosophy Essay** that articulates your beliefs, values, and principles about teaching and learning. In your essay, discuss your view of the role of the teacher and learners, how learning takes place, the importance of creating an inclusive and supportive learning environment, and the teaching strategies you believe are most effective. Connect your beliefs to your observations and personal experiences during your Field Study 1 and 2, and relevant educational theories or principles, and explain how these beliefs will guide your future teaching practice. Your essay should be clear, reflective, well-organized, and grounded in your developing professional identity as future educator.

RUBRIC FOR GRADING:

CRITERIA	EXCELLENT	PROFICIENT	DEVELOPING	BEGINNING
Teaching and Learning Beliefs (25%)	Clearly and thoughtfully articulates well-developed beliefs about teaching and learning, supported by relevant educational principles or theories.	Clearly presents relevant beliefs about teaching and learning with some connection to educational principles.	Presents general beliefs but provides limited explanation or connection to educational principles.	Provides unclear, limited, or unsupported beliefs about teaching and learning.
Role of Teacher and Learners (25%)	Provides a clear and insightful discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners and their relationship in the learning process.	Clearly discusses the roles of the teacher and learners with appropriate explanation.	Discusses the roles of the teacher and learners but with limited depth or clarity.	Provides minimal or unclear discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners.
Application to Practice Teaching (25%)	Clearly explains how the philosophy will guide specific teaching practices, classroom decisions, and interactions with diverse learners.	Explains how the philosophy can guide future teaching practice with relevant examples.	Provides general connections to future teaching practice with limited examples.	Makes little or no connection between the philosophy and future teaching practice.
Reflection and Professional Identity (25%)	Demonstrates deep self-reflection and clearly connects personal experiences and insights to the development of a professional teaching identity.	Demonstrates thoughtful reflection and makes relevant connections to professional growth.	Includes some reflection but connections to professional identity are limited.	Shows little evidence of reflection or developing professional identity.

MY TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

NAME OF PRE-SERVICE TEACHER: JOHN BRIX G. CORONEJO

TITLE: BEYOND THE BLUEPRINT: GUIDING HANDS, EMPOWERING MINDS

To me, education is not about pouring information into a student's mind; it is about guiding them to discover what they can build, fix, and achieve with their own hands and intellect. Grounded in constructivist thinking, I believe learning happens best through experience and active engagement. In vocational and technical fields especially, reciting theory from a textbook does little good if a student cannot troubleshoot a real-world problem or apply the concept in practice. True understanding occurs when learners interact directly with tools, collaborate with peers, and connect abstract principles to meaningful, practical tasks. Because learning is an active process, the traditional dynamic where a teacher simply lectures while students quietly listen is ineffective. I view the teacher's primary role as a facilitator, instructional guide, and mentor. My job is to structure a safe, organized environment, demonstrate proper techniques, break down complex tasks into manageable steps, and offer steady feedback. The students, on the other hand, are the true drivers of their learning journey. They bring their own backgrounds and curiosity into the room, and their responsibility is to take ownership of the work, practice deliberately, and learn to think through difficulties independently. Our relationship should be a partnership built on mutual respect and open communication, where students feel guided rather than micromanaged.

Creating an inclusive and emotionally supportive classroom is just as vital as providing the right tools and materials. When students feel judged, intimidated, or afraid of making mistakes, their learning shuts down. During my field observations, I noticed that students often held back from participating simply because they feared being wrong in front of their peers. Because of this, I believe in fostering an environment where errors are treated not as failures, but as necessary troubleshooting steps. True inclusivity also means recognizing that learners work at different paces and learn through different senses. By presenting lessons through visual diagrams, verbal explanations, and hands-on demonstrations, I can ensure that every student has an equal path to understanding, regardless of where they are starting from. To make these principles come alive, I rely on experiential and student-centered teaching strategies. The most effective method in my experience is project-based learning paired with cognitive modeling—the "I do, we do, you do" approach. First, I demonstrate the procedure while thinking aloud, showing how to approach the task and handle common pitfalls. Next, students work through guided practice in small groups where they can support one another. Finally, they carry out the task independently, learning to verify their work and troubleshoot on their own. Reinforcing these activities with brief reflective discussions helps students analyze why something worked or failed, turning routine practice into lasting competence.

My time in Field Study 1 and 2 grounded these ideas in reality. It taught me that teaching is never just about executing a lesson plan flawlessly; it requires adaptability, patience, and empathy. Seeing the pride in a student's eyes when they finally mastered a challenging hands-on task after struggling reaffirmed why I chose this path. As I step into practice teaching and my future career, this philosophy will guide my daily decisions—reminding me to teach with patience, respect each learner's unique pace, and help students build the skills and confidence they need to succeed in life.